

EXPERIENCE

Jose Tupayachi is a Data and AI Engineer specializing in scalable data engineering, machine learning, and multimodal AI. His expertise includes building end-to-end data platforms using Apache Spark, Databricks, cloud data warehouses, and modern MLOps practices, while integrating large language models (LLMs), retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), and multimodal AI into production workflows. His research and applied work span materials science (SEM image analysis), AI-powered freight transportation digital twins, geospatial analytics, and mobile application development. He has published in *Computers & Electrical Engineering* and the *Health Informatics Journal*, and has filed intellectual property disclosures at Oak Ridge National Laboratory.

EDUCATION

- **Ph.D.**, Industrial Engineering, University of Tennessee, Knoxville, May 2024 – Present
Advisor: Dr. Xueping Li | Dr. Xiao-Ying Yu
- **M.S.**, Industrial Engineering, University of Tennessee, Knoxville, Aug 2022 – May 2024
- **B.S.**, Industrial Engineering, Pontifical Catholic University of Peru, March 2014 – Aug 2020

PROFESSIONAL POSITIONS

Programmer & Researcher, Oak Ridge National Laboratory / ORISE Mar 2025–Present
AI researcher developing multimodal foundation models and scientific AI systems for materials science, fusion energy, and geospatial intelligence under DOE-funded programs.

- Built Vision Transformer (ViT) and foundation vision models for scanning electron microscopy (SEM) analysis, enabling automated microstructure characterization, defect detection, and phase identification in materials datasets.
- Developed multimodal AI pipelines integrating large language models (LLMs), retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), and scientific knowledge bases to accelerate materials discovery and experimental interpretation.
- Designed AI-agent systems for autonomous literature mining, scientific knowledge extraction, and research workflow automation across materials science domains.
- Created explainable ML models for extreme weather and environmental systems using large-scale atmospheric and geospatial datasets.
- Developed geospatial AI interfaces enabling natural-language querying and interactive analytics over scientific spatial datasets.
- Built LLM-powered scientific decision-support systems and automated dashboards for research exploration and data-driven discovery.

Graduate Research Assistant, University of Tennessee, Knoxville Jul 2024–Present
Researcher in AI-driven transportation systems, digital twins, and multimodal machine learning for mobility, healthcare, and infrastructure applications.

- Lead development of AI-powered freight transportation digital twins under the DOE ARPA-E RECOIL project, focusing on spatiotemporal prediction and system optimization.
- Designed and implemented deep learning architectures (MLP, CNN, LSTM, transformer-based models) for predictive analytics across mobility, healthcare, and infrastructure datasets.
- Developed multimodal ML systems for mobile health applications (SmartShots, ACTAPP) and cancer staging automation pipelines.
- Contributed to graph-based and spatiotemporal modeling frameworks for large-scale transportation simulation and decision-making.
- Mentored junior researchers in experimental design, model development, and computational research workflows.

Teaching Assistant – IE406/408: Simulation, University of Tennessee, Knoxville Spring 2022

- Supported instruction in discrete-event simulation and led lab sessions.
- Assisted with AnyLogic modeling assignments and graded coursework.

Teaching Assistant – IE483: Reliability Engineering, University of Tennessee, Knoxville Fall 2022

- Assisted with reliability analysis topics including Weibull distributions, failure mode analysis, and fault tree construction.
- Held office hours and graded exams.

Data Engineer, Indra Mar–Aug 2022
Data engineer supporting enterprise-scale ETL pipelines, distributed data processing, and cloud migration for large-scale analytics systems.

- Built and maintained scalable ETL/ELT pipelines using Python and Shell scripting for high-volume enterprise data workflows.
- Developed distributed data processing systems using Apache Spark, Hadoop, and HQL, including Oracle-to-lakehouse and SaaS migrations.
- Implemented CI/CD automation for data pipelines using Jenkins, improving deployment reliability and update cycles.
- Strengthened data quality and governance through validation frameworks, monitoring checks, and performance optimization strategies.
- Optimized Spark workloads through memory tuning and distributed resource allocation.

Business Intelligence Analyst, Globokas

Jan–Mar 2022

BI analyst designing data-driven reporting systems, dashboards, and analytical models for business decision support.

- Developed executive dashboards and KPI reporting systems to support strategic and operational decision-making.
- Integrated heterogeneous data sources (APIs, internal systems, external platforms) into unified analytics pipelines.
- Translated business requirements into analytical models and actionable insights for cross-functional stakeholders.

Data Analyst, Enel Distribución

Nov 2020–Dec 2021

Data analyst building predictive models, customer segmentation systems, and automated reporting tools for energy operations.

- Applied unsupervised learning techniques (clustering) to improve customer segmentation and optimize payment collection processes.
- Built interactive dashboards using Power BI and Tableau for operational monitoring and executive reporting.
- Managed SQL/T-SQL databases and Salesforce integrations ensuring data integrity and reliable reporting pipelines.
- Developed a PyQt-based desktop application to automate invoice verification and streamline billing workflows.

Developer – Portfolio Valuation, GPS Management

Aug–Nov 2020

- Implemented machine learning models for non-performing loan recovery and portfolio valuation.
- Automated scoring workflows, reducing manual processing time.

Professional IT Intern, Superintendencia de Banca, Seguros y AFP

Sep–Oct 2020

- Supported IT infrastructure and regulatory data management.
- Assisted in database maintenance and internal reporting for financial supervision operations.

IT Intern, Administradora Clínica Ricardo Palma

Feb–Aug 2019

- Developed and maintained internal healthcare information systems.
- Supported electronic health record integration and database administration for clinical operations.

FUNDED PROJECTS

Oak Ridge National Laboratory

Mar 2025–Present

Role: Research Fellow. Deployed advanced computer vision, multimodal AI, and scientific computing systems for materials science and engineering applications. Developed Vision Transformer (ViT) architectures, foundation vision models, and AI-assisted characterization pipelines for scanning electron microscopy (SEM) imagery, enabling automated materials analysis, microstructure characterization, defect detection, feature extraction, and accelerated materials discovery workflows. By integrating large language models, multimodal foundation models, retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), and domain-specific scientific knowledge, built intelligent research platforms that transform complex experimental and simulation data into actionable insights for scientists and engineers.

Funding: DOE Office of Science (SC), Fusion Energy Sciences (FES) – Fusion Materials Sciences Program; DOE Office of Environmental Management (EM), Nuclear Safety Research and Development (NSRD).

- Developed AI-agent workflows for materials discovery, scientific knowledge extraction, and literature exploration.
- Built computer vision, Vision Transformer (ViT), and foundation vision models for scanning electron microscopy (SEM) image characterization and materials science applications.
- Applied multimodal AI systems to automate microstructure analysis, defect identification, phase characterization, and feature extraction from scientific imagery.
- Developed AI-driven characterization pipelines supporting fusion materials research and advanced materials performance evaluation.
- Designed explainable machine learning models for extreme weather event prediction using atmospheric, environmental, and sensor datasets.
- Developed geospatial AI interfaces enabling natural-language interaction with spatial datasets and advanced analytics workflows.
- Created automated dashboard generation and scientific decision-support systems using large language models, retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), and modern web technologies.

Automated Geospatial Analysis Interface – engineered an end-to-end interface driven by large language models, enabling non-expert users to query, process, and visualize spatial datasets through natural language. *IP disclosure filed, ORNL, 2025.*

RECOIL – Cognitive Freight Transportation Digital Twin for Resiliency and Emission Control Through Optimizing Intermodal Logistics Jul 2024–Present Designed ontology-guided optimization models for large-scale freight transportation networks, integrating data from GIS-based transport modes (road, rail, waterways) to minimize costs and emissions.

Leveraged Convolutional Neural Networks and Graph Neural Networks to analyze the impacts of weather, traffic, and demand on EV charging behavior, enabling data-driven, real-time optimization.

Applied large language models to power a chatbot providing domain-specific trade-off analysis between cost, time, and CO_2 emissions for non-technical users.

Designed a real-time feedback loop for digital twins using simulated sensor data and scraping techniques to continuously optimize intermodal system performance.

Investigated BERT and sentence transformers for domain literature QA with accurate and reproducible responses.

Collaborated with Oak Ridge National Laboratory researchers to create industry-ready solutions.

Developed the unified UI using Flutter at <https://m1.recoil.ise.utk.edu>.

Funding Agency: U.S. Department of Energy ARPA-E *Project:* #DE-AR0001780

SmartShots – Cross-Platform Application to Improve Childhood Vaccination Rates in Tennessee Dec 2023–Dec 2024 Enhanced vaccination tracking with real-time data updates, notifications, and alerts; developed a scalable Laravel backend and cross-platform Dart/Flutter frontend.

Integrated community health information for real-time access to nearby vaccination providers; collaborated with the Tennessee Department of Health.

<https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.ilab.smartshots>

<https://apps.apple.com/us/app/smartshots-tn/id6526502640>

Funding Agency: Tennessee Department of Health

Active Caregiver's Toolkit (ACTAPP) – Mobile App for Physical Activity Among Rural Appalachian Caregivers at Risk for CVD

Jul 2024–Present Developed the ACT APP targeting cardiovascular disease risk reduction through physical activity

interventions; implemented Dart 3.0, Material Design, and state management using GetX.

Integrated ChatBot for FAQ answering and page/interaction tracking metrics for data analysis.

<https://testflight.apple.com/join/PehxA8aW>

https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.ilabutk.fe_rich

Funding Agency: Hillman Emergent Innovation (HEI)

HONORS AND AWARDS

2025–2026	IISE Future Faculty Fellows, USA – Selected
2024	Best Paper Award , CIE51 (51 st Conference on Computers and Industrial Engineering), Sydney, Australia “Emerging AI and Cognitive Digital Twin Technologies Towards Low-Carbon Multimodal Freight Transport Systems”
2024	IISE DAIS Student Mobile App Competition – Winner , SmartShots Project, Montreal https://www.iise.org/Details.aspx?id=33697
2024	HIDA Helmholtz Visiting Researcher , Karlsruhe Institute of Technology (KIT), Germany – Awarded not taken
2022–2024	Holiday Fellowship , University of Tennessee, Knoxville (2022, 2023, 2024)

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

TH Wyatt, S Lowe, J Tupayachi, X Li, CA McNeely, X Wang, PD Taylor et al., **Design and usability testing of SmartSHOTS: A mobile app to reduce vaccine barriers for children 0–24 months**, *Health Informatics Journal* 32(1) (2026).

J Tupayachi, AN Khan, X Li, **Scalable decentralized prognostics for industrial systems under data heterogeneity**, *Computers and Electrical Engineering* 133, 111023 (2026).

J Tupayachi, H Xu, OA Omitaomu, MC Camur, A Sharmin, X Li, **Towards next-generation urban decision support systems through AI-powered construction of scientific ontology using large language models**, *Smart Cities* 7(5), 2392–2421 (2024).

J Tupayachi, MM Ferguson, X Li, **A Simulation-Based Real-Time Deep Reinforcement Learning Approach for Fighting Wildfires**, *ANNSIM 2024*, 1–12 (2024).

H Xu, X Li, J Tupayachi, JJ Lian, OA Omitaomu, **Automating Bibliometric Analysis with Sentence Transformers and RAG**, *Proc. 2nd ACM SIGSPATIAL Workshop on Advances in Urban-AI* (2024).

X Li, J Tupayachi, A Sharmin, M Martinez Ferguson, **Drone-aided delivery methods, challenges, and the future: A methodological review**, *Drones* 7(3), 191 (2023).

J Tupayachi, L Silva, **Better Efficiency on Non-performing Loans Debt Recovery and Portfolio Valuation Using Machine Learning Techniques**, *POMS Lima, Peru* (2022).

Pre-Prints

X Li, H Xu, J Tupayachi, O Omitaomu, X Wang, **Empowering Cognitive Digital Twins with Generative Foundation Models: Developing a Low-Carbon Integrated Freight Transportation System**, *arXiv:2410.18089* (2024).
J Tupayachi, MC Camur, K Heaslip, X Li, **Predicting Electric Vehicle Charging Station Demand: Spatial-Temporal GNNs with Integrated Weather and Traffic Data**, *arXiv:2510.09048* (2024).
J Tupayachi, X-Y Yu, X Li, Z Liu, K Birdwell, **Explainable Machine Learning for Extreme Weather Event Prediction at the Oak Ridge Reservation**, *SSRN 6409258* (2025).
H Xu, J Tupayachi, X-Y Yu, **Context-Aware Visual Prompting: Automating Geospatial Web Dashboards with Large Language Models and Agent Self-Validation for Decision Support**, *arXiv:2511.20656* (2025).
J Tupayachi et al., **Automated End-to-End Geospatial Analysis: An AI-Driven Interface**, *arXiv* (2025).

Submitted Papers

H Xu, Y Sun, J Tupayachi, O Omitaomu, S Zlatanova, X Li, **Towards Autonomous Urban Logistics Optimization via Generative AI and Agentic Digital Twins**, *Computers & Industrial Engineering* (ID: CAIE-D-25-05889).
J Tupayachi et al., **CliniSense AI for Automated Clinical Skills Assessment with Real-Time Feedback**, *npj Digital Medicine*.
J Tupayachi, MC Camur, K Heaslip, X Li, **Spatio-Temporal GCNs for EV Charging Demand Forecasting**, *Applied Energy* (ID: 30181).

Upcoming Publications

Automated Control: The Tragedy of the Commons in End-to-End AI-Driven Systems
Literature Survey for New Materials Discovery Powered by AI Agents
Vision Transformer-Based Quality Assurance Engine for Wind Speed and Direction Classification

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, R, SAS, STATA, SPSS, Bash, Dart, PHP, Java, C++ , CUDA. **Data Engineering:** Delta Lake, Databricks Workflows, Unity Catalog, Spark, dbt, Airflow, Prefect; batch and streaming ETL/ELT, data quality, and monitoring/alerting. **Data Platforms:** Snowflake, lakehouse and data-warehouse architecture, query authoring, and performance optimization. **Analytics:** Statistical modeling, clustering, cross-sectional and panel-data regression; analytics and ML data pipelines. **Frameworks:** Django, Flask, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Flutter, Laravel. **IoT:** Arduino, ESP32. **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL, SQL Server. **DevOps:** Docker, Git, Jenkins, CI/CD, AWS, KVM, Slurm. **Optimization:** Gurobi, CPLEX, AnyLogic, NetworkX; model tuning and calibration. **Integration:** REST and GraphQL APIs; data-privacy-aware design. **GIS:** WMS, GeoServer, OverPass API.

SYNERGISTIC ACTIVITIES

Community Service. **University of Tennessee Graduate Student Senate** – Senator, Industrial and Systems Engineering, 2025. Represented students, advocated for academic and professional development opportunities, and fostered graduate student engagement.

Journal & Conference Reviewer. PLOS ONE; Information Systems Frontiers (Springer); IUI 2026 (IEEE/ACM); Journal of Asian Architecture and Building Engineering (Elsevier); IEEE Internet of Things Magazine; Software: Practice and Experience (Wiley); IISE Transactions (Taylor & Francis); Optimization Letters (Springer Nature); Journal of Robotics (Wiley); Journal of Sensors (Wiley); Winter Simulation Conference 2025; IISE Annual Conference 2025; IEOM 2025.

Conference Presenter. Federated Learning Fault Detection: Towards a Decentralized ML Framework – IISE 2023. Rule-based Automated Cancer Staging from Scanned Pathology Reports – IISE 2024. Empowering Simulation Modeling: An Automated Ontology Framework Enhanced by LLMs – INFORMS 2024. Conversational Geographic Question Answering: LLMs & Continuous RAG – SIGSPATIAL 2024. Automated Literature Review for Solid Lithium Breeder – ANS Annual Meeting 2025, Denver, Colorado.